

Give your Android a makeover

With customization as its middle name (or is it its last name?), Android does offer the ability to tweak the OS in your smartphone quite extensively <http://bit.ly/wJSuwW>

Nokia lays off 4000

Nokia plans to lay off 4000 employees from Europe and Mexico and shift production to Asia <http://bit.ly/yRYeza>

Design mantra

Exceptional product design resonates among all of us. To better understand the design philosophy behind modern laptops, in general, and ThinkPads, in particular, we sat down with Lenovo's Chief Designer, David Hill

Jayesh Shinde

jayesh.shinde@thinkdigit.com

Q Why is the existing laptop design the way it is? Why haven't we seen overhauls for the classic clamshell design since the mid-80s?

Often mature product categories achieve a certain level of configuration stability. For instance, in the early development days of bicycles, designers explored many ideas, even including concepts using radically different sized wheels. Eventually the product stabilised around two wheels of similar size. Even though the clamshell has become the stable laptop design, we're still innovating and trying new ideas. Our recently introduced IdeaPad Yoga is a great example of bending the rules – it's a great laptop and tablet.

Q When it comes to laptop design, what are the key norms that ThinkPads follow and always conform to?

We always strive to deliver a superior ownership experience, and that's why we spend so much time on the design of our keyboard: we'll never compromise on the typing experience. To do so would be like using a poorly designed steering wheel for a car. We consider, model and test every touch point on the keyboard to ensure superiority for the user.

Q Give us a brief account of a ThinkPad's journey from the drawing board to the



David Hill, Product Design Group, Lenovo

Q finished product? Are there any key steps in the process?

The most interesting step is the one I call brainstorming. In this step, my team works with our marketing team and customer feedback to develop actions for improving the design. It's about looking for ways to improve the design of the previous generation. Appearance, overall quality, ease-of-use and inventive features all come into play.

Q The physical design of a computer has come a long way and is constantly evolving,

Q aspiring to be stylish and sexy. How does ThinkPad fit into this design landscape?

The ThinkPad laptop brand/design has led in design for a long time. For example, the Museum of Modern Art includes the ThinkPad 701c in its permanent design collection. I love seeing a Picasso painting and a ThinkPad laptop together in the same museum.

Today, we continue to evolve the design and invent new experiences that I hope will inspire new generations of ThinkPad users. A simple black box never goes out of style.